

I Winning Hearts and Minds



SWARAJ (CENTRE)
AT THE CONVENTION

The men in the BP's top brass like L.K. Advani, Arun Jaitley, Gopinath Munde, Rajnath Singh and Yashwant Sinha stayed away but Sushma Swaraj chose to speak her heart on good governance during the party's national convention at Uttan in Mumbai. She concluded the session with tips on improving the relationship between the Opposition and ruling parties. Swaraj said that an Opposition would be less aggressive if the Government gave priority to their leaders in appointments. Swaraj recommended that important bills be discussed with the Opposition before the start of an assembly session to ensure their smooth passage. There were other tips to the state Government to get into their Opposition's good books: hosting at least three dinners for opposition leaders in a year, visiting ill MPs in hospital or even sending them flowers. **by Mitali Patel**

I Lesson Plan

THE COACHING CLASSES RACKET HAS NOW FORCED MAHARASHTRA COLLEGE TEACHERS TO DECLARE THEIR ASSETS.

In the wake of the Bombay High Court's comment, the Maharashtra Government has made it compulsory for college teachers to declare their movable and immovable assets. The rule applies to all the teachers working at government-aided and non-agricultural colleges. The step has been taken to keep a check on those college teachers who spend most of their time in coaching classes rather than college classrooms. The Government aims to make them focus on teaching, training and research in the college itself instead of just making money. A circular to bring the rule into effect has already been sent to the colleges. **by Mitali Patel**

YEDDYURAPPA PICKS NEW WARDROBE FOR INVESTORS' MEET

A Changed Man

Chief Minister B.S. Yeddyurappa is not new to suits. But at the recent global investors' meet in Bangalore, he went the whole hog, from an Italian-style business suit to a Nehru-type bandgala. He was goaded into a wardrobe change by his children who tapped a local designer to match the elegance of industry titans like Lakshmi Mittal, Kumar Mangalam Birla, Azim Premji and Venu Srinivasan who shared the dais at the meet. A farmer's son, Yeddyurappa does wear suits when he goes abroad, especially on state-related road shows. "Now his image must match reality. His Government must deliver results just as much as his looks are dapper," says state Congress working president D.K. Shivakumar. **by Stephen David**



I Road Show

The political battle between the ruling BSP and the Opposition SP has hit the road. The BSP headquarters is situated on Lal Bahadur Shastri Road in Lucknow while the SP office is on Vikramaditya Marg. The former is washed almost daily and properly maintained by the Public Works Department (PWD) officials even as Vikramaditya Marg stands neglected. This road, on which Leader of the Opposition Shivpal Singh Yadav also stays, has been dug up for over two months by the PWD for laying sewer lines. Neither PWD chief Tribhuvan Ram nor principal secretary, Ravindra Singh seem concerned about its pitiable condition. "Even if the two parties are locked in a political fight, the officials should not join it," said SP MLAs Yashwant Singh and Arvind Singh Gope. **by Subhash Mishra**